

PLAYBOOK 01 — GOOGLE ADS

Full-Funnel Acquisition

From Search Intent to Measurable Acquisition across Search, Performance Max, Display & YouTube

Platform: MNF.ai | India & US Campaigns

Document Type: Professional Case-Study & Operational Playbook

₹5L+

BUDGET MANAGED

30.8K+

AD CLICKS

10.5K+

ACCOUNT
REGISTRATIONS

2.8K+

YOUTUBE SUBS

Business Context & Objectives

Building a Measurable Acquisition Engine for MNF.ai, an AI-powered SaaS platform for filmmakers and screenwriters. The objective was to generate scalable registrations across India and US markets under disciplined budget controls.

STARTING CONSTRAINT & CORE CHALLENGE

Starting Constraint: Controlled testing budget with limited historical conversion data. The primary mandate was learning efficiently before committing additional scale.

The Core Question: What are filmmakers and screenwriters actually searching for, which of those searches indicate meaningful intent, and how can Google Ads progressively concentrate spend around the strongest signals?

Strategic Objectives

- Discover actual search behaviour rather than relying on assumed keyword demand.
- Build relevant and tightly themed Search campaigns.
- Reduce irrelevant traffic and budget leakage through rigorous negative-keyword hygiene.
- Convert validated search intent into registrations and build mature conversion signals.
- Use Display/Remarketing and YouTube/Demand Gen to support the wider acquisition ecosystem.

CORE OPERATING PRINCIPLE

“Search intent is more valuable than search volume.”

Campaign Scope: One Google Ads Ecosystem

Search was the primary acquisition engine, with PMax, Display/Remarketing and YouTube/Demand Gen supporting broader acquisition objectives.

01 — SEARCH (Primary Engine)

Focused on search-intent discovery, themed ad groups, match-type progression, search terms analysis, negative-keyword hygiene, and direct registration acquisition.

Strongest Evidence: 30.8K+ clicks · 10.5K+ registrations

02 — PERFORMANCE MAX

Conversion-led expansion leveraging conversion signals, asset groups, and audience signals. PMax complemented Search by expanding reach as conversion data matured.

03 — DISPLAY & REMARKETING

Visual remarketing layer used for re-engaging previous website visitors and nurturing acquisition drop-offs across the broader user journey.

04 — YOUTUBE / DEMAND GEN

Video-led Google inventory supporting audience development, video engagement, and brand exposure.

Result: 2.8K+ YouTube subscribers gained.

Measurement Note: Campaign scope is based on available platform records. Channel-specific results are presented only where supported by available quantitative evidence.

Search Strategy: Discover & Validate

Search was the primary acquisition engine. Rather than assuming high-volume keywords represented valuable demand, the strategy used campaign data to discover real search behaviour first.

Phase 01 — Discover

Structured Broad Match: Deployed Broad Match around long-tail screenwriting themes as an intent-discovery mechanism to uncover unmapped phrasing.

Tightly Themed Ad Groups: Grouped related intent into focused themes to maintain relevance between queries, ads, and landing experiences.

Search Terms Analysis: Shifted focus from high-volume assumptions to identifying actual searches demonstrating useful intent.

Phase 02 — Validate

Negative-Keyword Hygiene: Added 100+ negative keywords (e.g., “free download”, “movie torrent”, “reviews”) to eliminate irrelevant traffic and protect budget.

Exact & Phrase Deployment: Validated terms moved into controlled structures (*Broad discovery* → *validated query* → *Exact/Phrase*) to maintain bid control and query relevance.

Dynamic Budget Allocation: Shifted capital toward higher-performing terms where evidence was strongest.

Bidding Evolution & Funnel System (Google Search Ad)

Bidding Evolution: Learning to Efficiency

The bidding approach evolved alongside the maturity of available conversion data, moving from traffic discovery toward acquisition efficiency.

CONTROLLED TESTING PHASE

Maximize Clicks

Used initially to generate traffic, test angles, and gather search and campaign-level learning.

MATURED CONVERSION DATA

Maximize Conversions

Shifted objective toward generating meaningful acquisition outcomes as conversion signals accumulated.

The Full-Funnel System Architecture

1. AD IMPRESSION (Targeted search & asset groups)



2. SEARCH INTENT (Filtered through negative hygiene)



3. CLICK (Engaged audience arriving via relevant ad)



4. RELEVANT LANDING PAGE (Aligned messaging)



5. STREAMLINED REGISTRATION (Reduced form to 2 fields)



6. REGISTRATION / PRODUCT ACTION (Downstream conversion signals tracked through GA4 and product analytics)

Measurement Stack & Decision Log (Google Search Ad)

Connecting paid traffic to on-page outcomes through a multi-layered measurement infrastructure.

MEASUREMENT STACK

- **Google Ads:** Campaign & conversion signals
- **GTM + GA4:** Events, traffic & conversions
- **Microsoft Clarity:** Behavioural analysis & friction
- **PostHog:** Product & user behaviour context
- **GSC:** Organic search visibility context

CORE OPERATING PRINCIPLE

Paid media performance cannot be evaluated independently from landing experience, user behavior, and downstream business outcomes.

Optimisation Decision Log

Signal Observed	Decision Taken	Strategic Rationale
Search query irrelevance	Added negative keywords through Search Terms audits	Reduced irrelevant traffic and protected daily budget
Validated search terms	Extracted high-performing queries into Exact Match structures	Increased bidding control around demonstrated intent
Conversion data matured	Moved bidding from Maximize Clicks to Maximize Conversions	Shifted from initial traffic learning to acquisition efficiency
Mobile landing friction	Audited behavioural data and compressed registration form to 2 fields	Reduced friction between click and signup

Results & Ecosystem Impact

Measurable acquisition achieved across the Google Ads ecosystem based on available platform records.

₹5L+

BUDGET MANAGED

30.8K+

AD CLICKS

10.5K+

ACCOUNT REGISTRATIONS

400K+

EVIDENCED IMPRESSIONS

16K+

TRACKED CONVERSION EVENTS/
SIGNALS

2.8K+

YOUTUBE SUBSCRIBERS GAINED

MARKET STRATEGY & PERFORMANCE EVIDENCE

(Observed ranges based on available campaign data — not benchmarks or averages)

INDIA — Efficiency + Scaling

Refined search intent, tightened keyword/query control, and reallocated bids and budget toward validated acquisition signals.

~6–15% CTR · ~₹3.5–₹4 CPC

~45–56% CVR · ~₹6–₹8 CPA/CPL

US — Optimization

Analysed campaign performance and conversion signals, refined targeting, and adjusted bids/budget to improve efficiency within available data.

~7–9% CTR · ~₹50–₹52 CPC

~18–40% CVR · ~₹126–₹291 CPA/CPL

Performance figures are based on available Google Ads platform data (Search & PMax Campaigns). Some historical campaign data is no longer available; figures therefore do not represent complete historical campaign coverage.

KEY TAKEAWAY

The Google Ads system evolved from traffic discovery toward tighter intent control, conversion-led bidding, and evidence-based budget allocation across India and US markets.

My Google Ads Operating System

- 01 — **UNDERSTAND:** Business objective, audience, funnel structure and unit economics.
- 02 — **DISCOVER:** Search behaviour, audiences and market opportunities.
- 03 — **BUILD:** Campaign architecture, tracking and landing experiences.
- 04 — **MEASURE:** Track clicks, conversions, behaviour and downstream signals.
- 05 — **FORM HYPOTHESES:** Identify the likely cause behind meaningful performance patterns.
- 06 — **TEST & OPTIMISE:** Validate the hypothesis, learn from the result and reallocate resources.
- 07 — **SCALE:** Increase investment only when evidence supports sustainable growth.

What This Playbook Demonstrates

Search-intent discovery · Google Ads campaign architecture · Match-type progression · Search-term analysis & negative-keyword management · Conversion tracking & measurement · Landing-page optimisation · Data-driven bidding evolution · Hypothesis-driven optimisation · Budget reallocation based on evidence · Full-funnel acquisition thinking · Disciplined scaling

PORTFOLIO SCOPE

Performance figures and campaign results from my work at MNF.ai across India & US are based on available platform records. The ₹5L+ Google Ads spend figures represent managed MNF.ai spend; additional historical spend was managed through older advertising accounts whose records are no longer accessible. The ₹15L+ total ads managed figure (Google Ads & Meta Ads) reflects cumulative career experience. Figures are rounded/approximate based on available data.